



WORLD ECONOMIC FORUM: INSIDE DAVOS



Scan to review worksheet

Expemo code:

1FDG-K1L2-2B0



1

Warm up

Complete the quiz below. Is any of the information surprising?

- Who gave the speech at Davos in 2019 that began with the words: "Our house is on fire"?
 - Al Gore
 - Greta Thunberg
 - Bill Gates
- Why was North Korea's invitation taken back in 2016?
 - They had recently conducted a nuclear test.
 - They had broken a deal with South Korea.
 - Their Foreign Minister insisted on travelling to Davos by Concorde.
- In 1988, leaders of which two countries signed a declaration at Davos that was said to have played a part in preventing them from going to war?
 - Russia and Finland
 - Turkey and Greece
 - Yugoslavia and Hungary
- Which of the following facts about Davos is true?
 - It is the source of the longest river in Europe.
 - It is the birthplace of skiing.
 - It is the highest town in Europe.
- How many people attended the first conference in 1971?
 - 17
 - 1400
 - 450



2

Focus on vocabulary

Part A: The following quotations are taken from the first part of the report about Davos. Before watching the video, complete the extracts below with the appropriate, given words and expressions

accountable apartheid lesser-known plays host pressing summit

1. ...the handshake between Nelson Mandela and former South African President de Klerk in 1992 symbolising the end of _____.
2. The Alpine resort town normally _____ to skiing and hiking enthusiasts.
3. But WEF isn't just a yearly _____ in the Alps.
4. Back in 1971, the then _____ engineer and economist brought his first meeting to Davos...
5. His objective was to encourage business leaders to be _____ to everyone...
6. ...gather 5000 ft above sea level to address the globe's most _____ challenges.

Part B: Match the definitions to the words and phrases from part A.

1. _____ (adj.): not widely recognised or acknowledged; having less fame or prominence compared to others
2. _____ (n): a policy or system of segregation or discrimination based on race
3. _____ (adj.): urgent, requiring immediate attention or action; demanding a swift response
4. _____ (n): the highest point or peak; a meeting or conference of leaders or representatives, often discussing important matters
5. _____ (phrase): act as the venue or location for an event; to be the organiser of a gathering, meeting, or activity
6. _____ (adj.): responsible or answerable for one's actions, decisions, or obligations; subject to being called to account



Part C: Now, watch the first part of the video (00:00–02:34) and put the completed sentences from part A in the correct order.

- _____ ...the handshake between Nelson Mandela and former South African President de Klerk in 1992 symbolising the end of
- _____ Back in 1971, the then ... engineer and economist brought his first meeting to Davos...
- _____ The Alpine resort town normally ... to skiing and hiking enthusiasts.
- _____ His objective was to encourage business leaders to be ... to everyone...
- _____ But WEF isn't just a yearly ... in the Alps.
- _____ ...gather 5000 ft above sea level to address the globe's most ... challenges.



3

Focus on vocabulary: phrases

Put a tick next to the sentence in which the underlined word or phrase is used correctly.

1.

- a. The business owner decided to raise trustee by offering equity to potential investors.
- b. The company appointed a trustee to handle the legal and financial aspects of the business.
- c. The duties of the trustee included mopping the floors and vacuum-cleaning the conference room.

2.

- a. Shareholders were pleased to receive a substantial initiative payment as a reward for their investment.
- b. Diversifying the initiative portfolio is a strategy employed to mitigate risk and enhance returns.
- c. The company launched a new initiative to promote employee well-being.

3.

- a. The company aims to foster a collaborative work environment by encouraging open communication.
- b. In order to foster higher profits, prices will be slashed.
- c. Many CEOs foster specialist staff to be part of their inner sanctum.

4.

- a. The Alps create natural confines between France and Italy.
- b. The manager addressed the team to discuss the current confines of productivity.
- c. Within the confines of the laboratory, scientists conducted experiments to explore new possibilities in medical research.

5.

- a. The team developed several prototypes to test and refine the product's design.
- b. The staff handed out free prototypes to the public outside the supermarket.
- c. The artist showcased a gallery of prototypes, each painting telling a unique and captivating story.

6.

- a. After several complaints from users, the item had to be launched at the factory.
- b. The wholesale brand launched the problems by introducing new software that was voice-activated.
- c. The company successfully launched its latest product, introducing innovative features to the market and garnering widespread attention.



4

Listening comprehension

Watch the second part of the video (02:34–04:36) and answer the questions true (T) or false (F).

1. All of the trustees are famous. _____
2. WEF operates on a global scale. _____
3. Sector-specific centres encourage the involvement of the general public. _____
4. WEF reports can help to shape education. _____
5. The various regional programmes WEF operates have come to be more important than Davos. _____

5

Focus on vocabulary

Add vowels to create words that match the definitions.

1. _ xp _ s _ r _ (n) - the visibility, attention, and awareness garnered by launching or promoting something
2. _ pt _ cs (n) - the presentation or perception of events, situations, or issues
3. _ rr _ y (n) - an impressive display or range of things
4. d _ bb _ d (v) - given a new name or title
5. _ ch _ | ch _ mb _ r (phrase) - an environment where individuals encounter only reinforcing information
6. sh _ ll _ _ t (phr. v) - spend or pay a significant amount of money
7. _ ffs _ t (v) - counterbalance or compensate for something
8. _ cc _ st _ m _ d (adj.) - being familiar with a situation due to regular exposure





6

Listening comprehension

Watch the final part of the video about Davos (04:36–06:52). Answer the multiple-choice questions below.

1. What is behind some people's decision to protest against the summit?
 - a. It has too many elections.
 - b. It showcases methods of tax evasion.
 - c. It celebrates income disparities.
 - d. It is a closed forum.
2. What factors contribute to the perceived inequity of WEF's annual meeting?
 - a. most attendees come from the two largest countries in the world
 - b. disparities based on gender
 - c. exclusive events that are organised to run alongside the main event
 - d. substantial financial benefits given to the Swiss public
3. How does Davos ensure only the super-rich can attend?
 - a. Attendees must pay an extortionate amount.
 - b. Attendees must go through an exhaustive vetting procedure.
 - c. Attendees must arrive by jet.
 - d. Attendees must earn a certain amount.
4. Which financial contributions are singled out as being important to WEF's funding?
 - a. membership fees
 - b. participation fees
 - c. donations
 - d. event sponsorships
5. What do climate activists assert regarding the environmental impact of attending Davos?
 - a. The money needed to attend Davos is insignificant when compared to the event's environmental benefits.
 - b. The cost of attending Davos is tiny when weighed against how it aids ecosystems in the long run.
 - c. The financial outlay needed to attend Davos pales in comparison to the environmental consequences attributed to the gathering.
 - d. The ecological impact of the event could be reduced by organising more regional WEF gatherings.



7

Talking point

In pairs or small groups, discuss the following questions.

1. Should WEF reconsider the format of its annual Davos meeting to address concerns about the environmental impact, especially in terms of private jet travel?
2. Is the criticism about the lack of financial transparency valid, or is it essential for the WEF to maintain a degree of freedom to address global issues effectively?
3. What do you think is the motivation for celebrities to attend the Davos summit?

8

Optional extension / homework

Write an essay to what extent you agree with the statement below. You should write at least 250 words, and check your grammar, spelling and punctuation.

"The World Economic Forum's annual summit in Davos is supposed to serve as a platform for global leaders to address pressing issues, but its exclusivity, high cost, and environmental impact raise significant ethical concerns."